

Pre-Launch Metrics: RunFund

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Informed Stakeholders	
Status	NOT STARTED / IN PROGRESS / DONE

 Summarize key points, dates, and deliverables. To change the style of this panel, select one of the options in the menu below.

Objective

I hope with this launch it will help users to stay motivated to stay active by providing a monetary incentive for either themselves or a charity they want to support and we will know if that happens by using the website to save money by setting a amount goal for how many miles they run/cycle/hike/etc.

Market Research

The category RunFund sits in is generally tracked as "move-to-earn fitness apps" (apps that turn physical activity into a reward of some kind — cash, crypto, discounts, or donations).

- 2024 market size: **\$669.9M**
- 2026 estimate: **\$942.7M**
- 2030 projection: **\$1.8B**
- CAGR (2025–2030): **17.7%**
- iOS leads on platform share (47.2%), smartphones dominate the device split (66.9%), and freemium is the fastest-growing payment model (41.1% share)
- North America holds the largest revenue share (36.7%); Asia Pacific is growing fastest

Growth is being driven by wearable/smartphone penetration, employers adding these apps to wellness programs, and AI/ML making personalization (like adaptive goal-setting) cheaper to build. That employer-wellness channel shows up again below in Charity Miles' model, and it's a distribution path worth keeping in mind for RunFund even at MVP stage.

Competitive Analysis

Charity Miles

- **Model:** Converts miles (walk, run, bike) into charity donations. The user never gets paid directly — money comes from three sources instead: personal fundraising pages (friends/family donate), corporate sponsors who fund per-mile rates, and employer wellness programs.
- **Gap relative to RunFund:** No personal savings option at all — it's charity-only, and the runner isn't the one funding the donation, a sponsor or donor is. That's a fundamentally different mechanic than "you pledge \$/mile out of your own pocket."
- **Known weaknesses:** User complaints about tracking/leaderboard reliability; no public numbers on active users or total raised (not disclosed in FAQ or app store material); some entity/branding inconsistency.
- Sources: [Charity Miles Review 2026 \(Fitcoin\)](#), [Charity Miles FAQ](#)

Sweatcoin

- **Model:** Advertising- and marketplace-driven. Steps earn in-app currency ("sweatcoins"), redeemable for brand discounts and offers; a crypto layer (SWEAT token) sits on top.
- **Scale:** ~150M registered users, 110M+ downloads since 2016 — the largest player in this space by far.
- **Gap relative to RunFund:** Not running-specific (counts general steps), not charity/savings-focused, and the token economy has badly eroded trust — minting difficulty has increased 5x since launch (1,000 steps per token at launch vs. 5,000+ now), SWEAT is down ~99.6% from its September 2022 all-time high, and a committed walker earns roughly \$1/year in real terms before fees. Current market cap is only ~\$4.4M despite the massive user base, and reviewers describe users feeling "misled" about the token's redeemable value.
- Sources: [Sweatcoin Review 2026 \(Fitcoin\)](#), [SWEAT token data \(CoinGecko\)](#)

StepBet (WayBetter)

- **Model:** Stake-based betting, not earning. Users pay ~\$40 to enter a 6-week challenge with personalized daily/weekly step goals (adjusted to the user's own tracker history); winners split the pool, platform takes a cut (waived for members).
- **Positioning:** Considered the established, "best first choice" option in the step-betting niche because of its personalization algorithm, versus competitors like Steppa (fixed goals that favor already-active users) or Motiv (peer-to-peer challenges).
- **Gap relative to RunFund:** It's a win/lose wager against other participants, not an automatic, ongoing per-mile contribution to your own savings or a charity. Typical payout is modest

(stake back plus a few dollars), and there's real risk of losing your stake if you miss goals — a very different psychological contract than "every mile banks you something."

- Sources: [Best Step-Betting Apps 2026 \(Fitcoin\)](#).

 Success metrics

Goal	Metrics
Have a variety of users	Signup aren't just one target audience
Users will use it for different activities	Users will use it to track their cycling, running, hiking, walking milage
Users will use it for personal savings	A user will save for their own personal goals
Users will use it for donating to charities	A user will save for a charity that they care about

 Target Personas

Type of persona	Profile
Buyer personas	
User Personas	Who they are: 29-40, active lifestyle, runs, cycles, hikes, or tracks steps regularly.
	Goal: saving toward a major life milestone (wedding, baby, home, emergency fund, kid's college fund), or wanting to donate to causes they care about while training or improving fitness.
	Frustration: no accountability partner for hitting mileage goals, and struggles to "set it and forget it" when it comes to saving, or to save consistently at all.
	Current tools: Strava, Garmin, Apple Health, Fitbit, Runna, Rocket Money, fitness tracking and money-saving live in separate apps that don't talk to each other.

What earns a yes: full control over how much and how often they pledge, no forced timeline or downside either way, plus the option to give back to their community instead of just training for themselves.

Quote: "Every step counts toward my goal. If I'm not doing it for myself, I'm doing it for my neighbor."

 Messaging & positioning

Product description

RunFund is a website (or app) that turns every mile you run into money saved or donated, so your training doubles as progress toward a savings goal or a charity you care about.

Short positioning statement

RunFund turns every mile active 29-40 year olds run into real progress toward a savings goal or a cause they care about, with no stakes or deadline.

Detailed positioning statement

For active 29-40 year olds working toward a life milestone (a wedding, a home, a family) or wanting to give back, RunFund is a mileage-to-savings-and-donation platform that turns every run, ride, or hike into progress toward a personal goal or a charity. It links to fitness trackers like Strava and calculates a per-mile pledge from the user's own money, solving the accountability and "set it and forget it" gap savings and donation apps haven't solved together. Unlike Charity Miles' sponsor-funded donations or StepBet's stake-to-win risk, RunFund lets users set their own pledge with nothing to lose.

Top-Line message	no-stakes or deadlines	choice of impact	activity & finance accountability
Product promise	RunFund lets you pledge your own money, on your own terms.	RunFund gives you the option to save for yourself or donate to a charity	When RunFund links up with Strava, you don't just track your

	There's no forced deadline and nothing to lose, you set the pace and the amount, and everything stays flexible enough to match your goals as they change.	you're passionate about. Either way, you're making an impact, whether that's progress toward something in your own life or support for a cause in your community.	mileage, you see exactly how much you've saved or given with every activity you complete, so you always know you're staying on track.
Customer pain points	Stake-based apps like StepBet require an entry fee with real risk of losing it if you miss a goal, which turns fitness into a gamble instead of a habit. Most people don't want their own money on the line for something as unpredictable as a training week.	Apps like Charity Miles make users feel disconnected from their own giving, since the donation usually comes from a sponsor or a fundraising page rather than money the runner actually committed themselves. There's no simple way to just choose for yourself whether your effort goes toward your own life or your community.	Runners don't have a built-in incentive tied to their miles, so motivation to keep logging runs can fade, and casual saving or donating habits rarely stick without an accountability partner.
Product proof points	Users set their own \$/mile pledge amount, with no entry fee, no wagered stake, and no	Users choose between a personal savings goal or a selected charity right at signup, and the	Strava integration automatically detects each run and calculates the pledge amount, with a one-tap

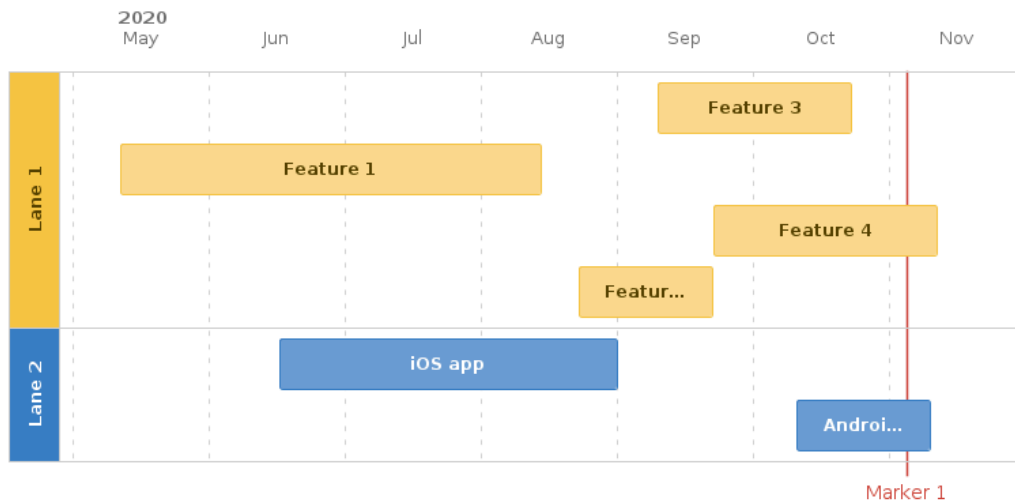
	subscription cost. Goals run at the user's own pace with no forced deadline, and a missed or short run carries no penalty.	pledge is self-funded rather than coming from a sponsor. Goals run one at a time, savings or charity, and reaching one lets you start a new goal on either path rather than editing the one you're on.	confirmation to move it. The optional "locked" mode hides the running total until a chosen date or milestone, so there's nothing to check in on and second-guess along the way.
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Pricing

RunFund is free to use at MVP, with no subscription tiers, packages, or paid features. Every core feature, mileage tracking, setting a per-mile pledge, linking a bank account, and choosing between personal savings or a charity, is available to all users at no cost. This is intentional: users are already committing their own money toward a goal they care about, so charging a subscription fee on top would work against the product's value rather than support it.

That said, this pricing is more of an early-stage decision than a permanent one. Automated bank transfers carry real recurring costs (Plaid charges per linked account, and moving money via ACH through a processor like Dwolla also carries per-transfer fees), so RunFund is effectively absorbing that infrastructure cost at MVP rather than passing it to users. Monetization, whether a modest fee once transfers are running at scale, ads, or employer/corporate wellness sponsorships, is intentionally deferred until the core mileage-to-pledge loop is validated with real users. Introducing pricing or ad infrastructure before that point would add complexity the MVP doesn't need, and risks charging people before they've seen enough value to justify it.

Product release roadmap



📣 Distribution channels & launch activities

Activity	Owner	Due date	Status	Notes
Internal comms				
Write a post for Strava	@sabrina grosse		NOT STARTED	
PR				
Post on Strava Account	@sabrina grosse			
Email				
runfund_help@gmail.com				
Blog				
Social				

Support plan

Support contact	@sabrina grosse
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Task	Owner	Due date	Status	Notes
Create Training Docs	@sabrina grosse		NOT STARTED	

Reference materials / Notes / Concerns

- [▶ Put your money where your feet are: The real-world effects of StepBet gamified deposit contracts for physical activity](#)
- [Move To Earn Fitness Apps Market Size Report \(Grand View Research\)](#)
- [Charity Miles Review 2026 \(Fitcoin\)](#)
- [Charity Miles FAQ](#)
- [Sweatcoin Review 2026 \(Fitcoin\)](#)
- [SWEAT token market data \(CoinGecko\)](#)
- [Best Step-Betting Apps 2026 \(Fitcoin\)](#)
- Will there be backlash to using this tech if it's only a website or would it be a good thing because it would be harder to alter the users set target amounts?
- Willingness to pay per mile out of pocket (vs. Charity Miles' sponsor-funded model or StepBet's stake-to-win model) — this is RunFund's biggest behavioral assumption and hasn't been tested by a direct comparable.
- Whether Strava-only tracking (per your current plan) is sufficient at MVP, or whether lack of Apple Health/Garmin support narrows the early adopter pool too much.
- Retention mechanics — Sweatcoin's collapse in perceived value came from the reward diluting over time; worth deciding early how RunFund keeps the per-mile value proposition from feeling worthless as usage scales.